Given that various stances have been attributed to me, including in Parliament, let me clarify. I was asked by the government in February 2016 for my views on demonetization, which I gave orally. Although there might be long-term benefits, I felt the likely short-term economic costs would outweigh them, and felt there were potentially better alternatives to achieve the main goals. I made these views known in no uncertain terms. I was then asked to prepare a note, which the RBI put together and handed to the government. It outlined the potential costs and benefits of demonetization, as well as alternatives that could achieve similar aims. If the government, on weighing the pros and cons, still decided to go ahead with demonetization, the note outlined the preparation that would be needed, and the time that preparation would take. The RBI flagged what would happen if preparation was inadequate.

The government then set up a committee to consider the issues. The deputy governor in charge of currency attended these meetings. At no point during my term was the RBI asked to make a decision on demonetization.

Enough said. Let me conclude this introduction with thanks. My wife was my constant support in Mumbai, as she has been all our life together. She could be relied upon to keep my feet firmly tethered to the ground, even while giving me the advice I needed. My children, who came home occasionally during the holidays, endured the absence of their parents, and helped give me a sense of normalcy at home after being 'The Governor' in the office. My parents and parents-in-law were an unconditional source of comfort, as always. I owe a debt to my colleagues at the RBI, who worked tirelessly with me, and received my family with warmth into their midst. And, finally, I thank Krishan Chopra of HarperCollins, without whose perseverance this book